

THE SENATE

- **Senators represent the interests and rights of Canada's regions, and especially Canada's minorities.** Senators are appointed by “division,” or region. At Confederation in 1867, the constitution identified three regions: the Maritimes, Ontario and Québec. The idea was to ensure that these regions had an equal voice in the Senate, and to ensure that Québec's Francophone population — a minority within Canada — had a strong voice within Canada. As provinces and territories joined Canada, new regions were added to the divisions for appointing senators.
- The Senate can propose laws, but **usually only considers bills passed first by the House of Commons. The Senate gives careful reconsideration** to all legislation proposed for Canada. This means senators provide a second round of study, debate and voting on laws proposed for Canada. Because the Senate provides a voice for regions in Canada, it brings a different perspective to issues that concern everyone.



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